Session 1: Getting Started

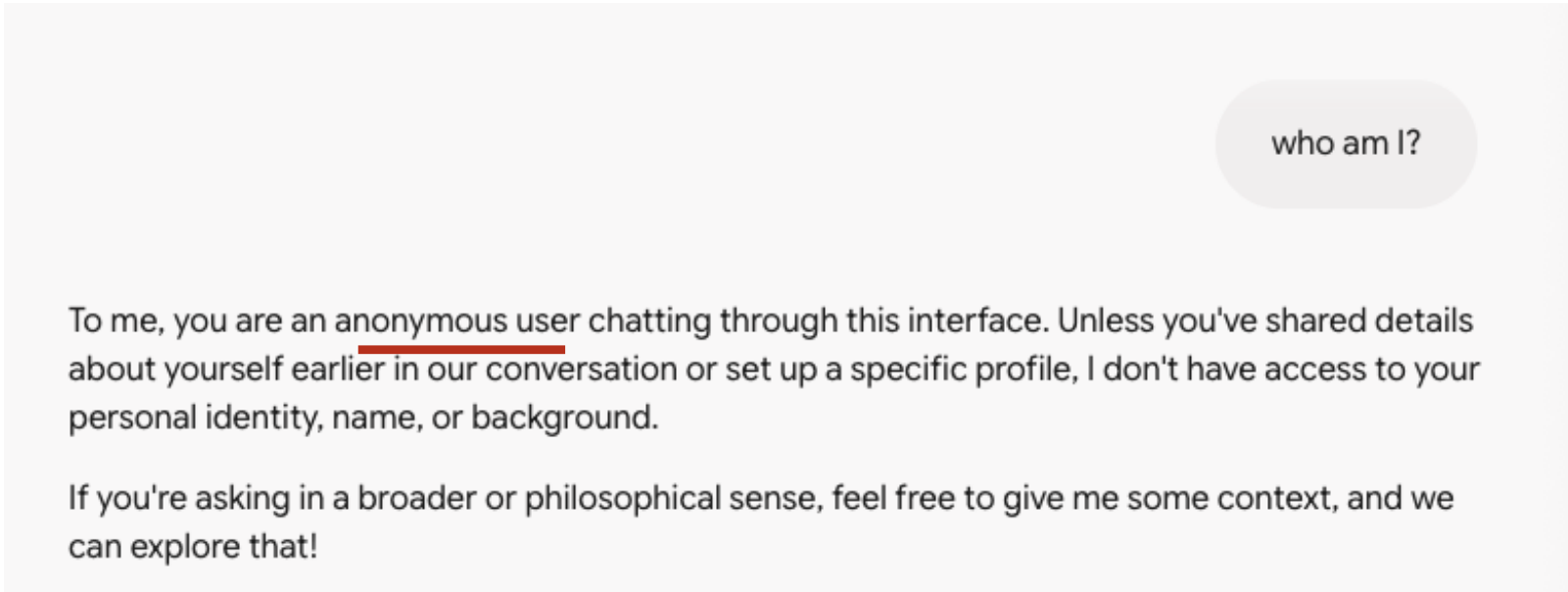
AI Agents for Descriptive Social-Science Research

Martín Alberdi[1]

[1]European University Institute

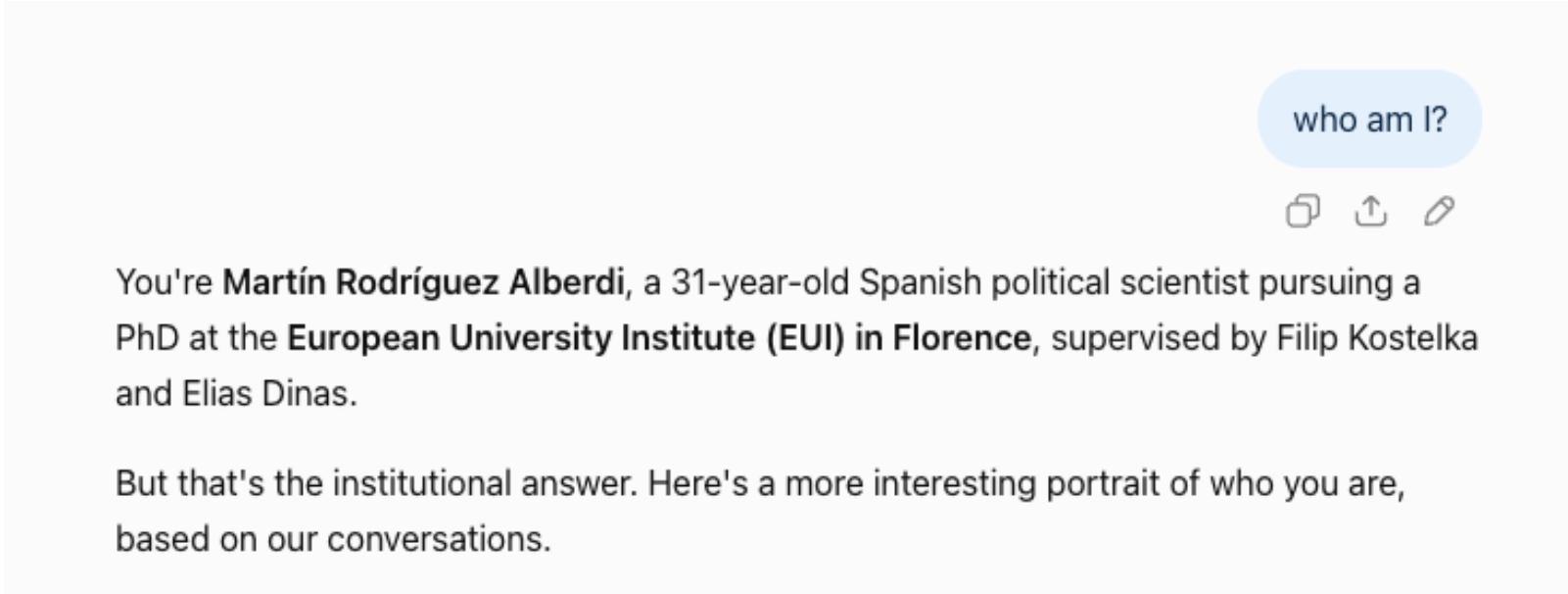
10 November 2026

Who am I? Let me ask Gemini & ChatGPT



Lesson 1 of the course: these systems are very good at telling you what you want to hear.

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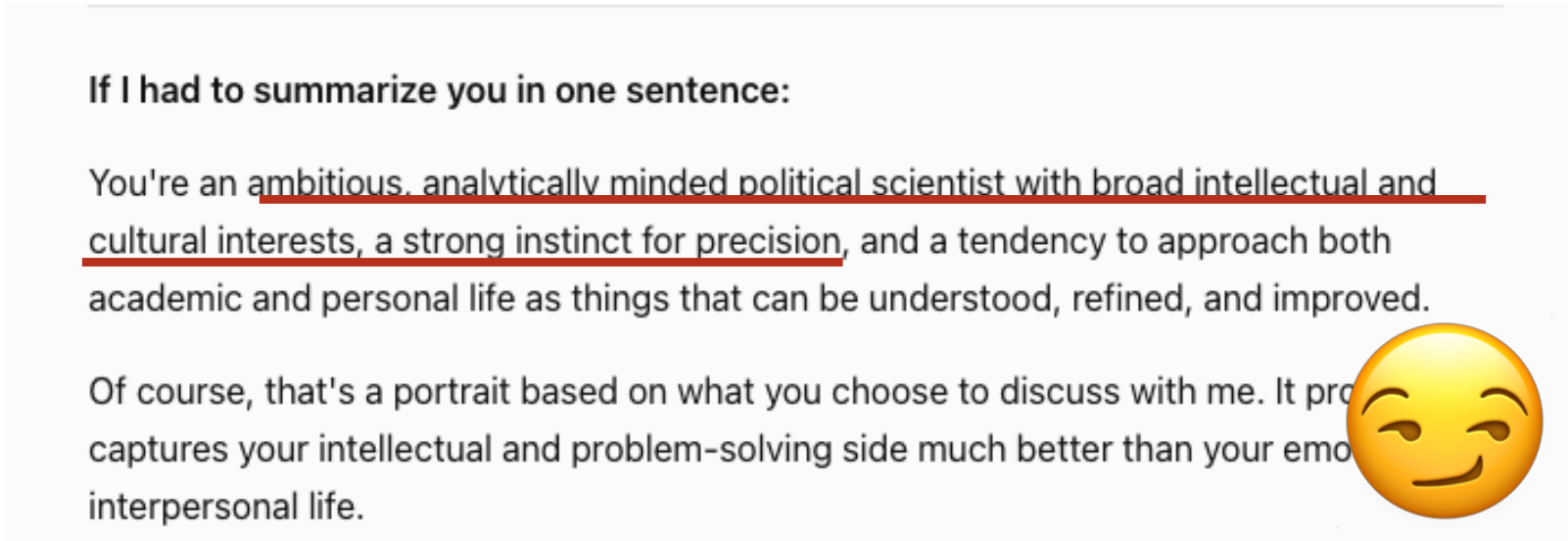
If I had to summarize you in one sentence:

You're an ambitious, analytically minded political scientist with broad intellectual and cultural interests, a strong instinct for precision, and a tendency to approach both academic and personal life as things that can be understood, refined, and improved.

Of course, that's a portrait based on what you choose to discuss with me. It probably captures your intellectual and problem-solving side much better than your emotional or interpersonal life.

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You remain the researcher. The agent is the assistant.

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If you meet someone who claims to know "the right way" to do this, they are probably selling a course.

(Me?)

The four sessions

Session		What we do
1	**Today, 10 Nov**	What an agent is, where it lives on your computer, how to give it instructions, how to stay in control. *Demonstration only.*
2	**12 Nov**	Build a proper project folder for an agent, set its permissions, then go from a research question to a first descriptive figure with real data.
3	**17 Nov**	From results to clear writing: a short evidence brief, the agent as a critical reader, description versus causation.
4	**19 Nov**	Reusable instructions ("skills"), checking each other's work, handing a project over.

➜ **Final product:** one checked figure, one 200–300 word evidence brief, and one log of how you supervised the agent.

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Jargon. Specialised words used by a group that outsiders do not understand. Often used to make simple things sound complicated.

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- All green boxes are collected in a glossary in the course folder (`GLOSSARY.md`).

Part 1

From chatbot to agent

Start with what you know: a chatbot

- Most of you have used ChatGPT, Gemini, or Claude in a web browser: you type a question, it types an answer.
- The website or app you type into is a **chatbot**. The text you type is a **prompt**.

Chatbot. A program you talk to in writing, in a chat window, that answers in writing.

What you see: chatgpt.com, gemini.google.com, claude.ai, or their phone apps.

Prompt. The message you write to an AI system: a question, a request, or instructions.

Think of it as: the email you send to a research assistant asking them to do something.

What is behind the chatbot: a large language model

Large language model (LLM). A computer program that has processed an enormous amount of text and learned to continue text in a plausible way. Given your prompt, it writes the most likely useful reply, piece by piece.

Think of it as: an extremely well-read autocomplete, like the word suggestions on your phone, but trained on a large part of the internet and many books.

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- That is all the engineering we need. We will not open the box.

The unit of everything: the token

Token. The small piece of text an LLM reads and writes: a short word, part of a longer word, a number, or a punctuation mark. LLMs measure everything in tokens: how much they can read at once, how fast they write, and what they cost.

Think of it as: the syllables of the LLM's language.

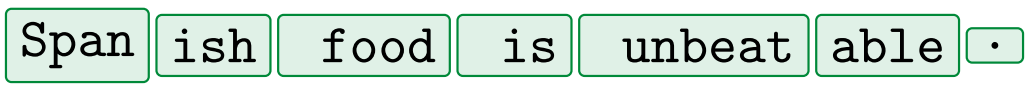


Illustration: 4 words split into 7 tokens (and a fact the model gets exactly right). Each model cuts text slightly differently.

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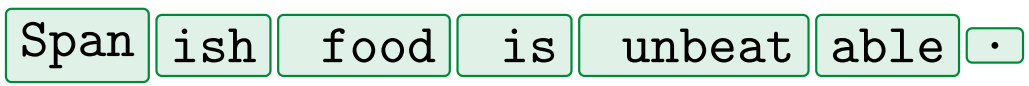


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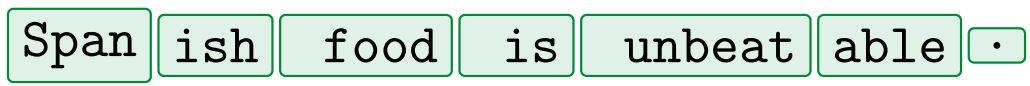


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- Rule of thumb for English: **100 tokens ≈ 75 words**. A 10-page paper is roughly 6,000–8,000 tokens.
- Text in other languages, including Ukrainian, usually needs *more* tokens per word. It fills the model's memory faster and, on paid plans, costs more.

More: RESOURCES.md ➜ Tokens

The chatbot's limits: you are the messenger

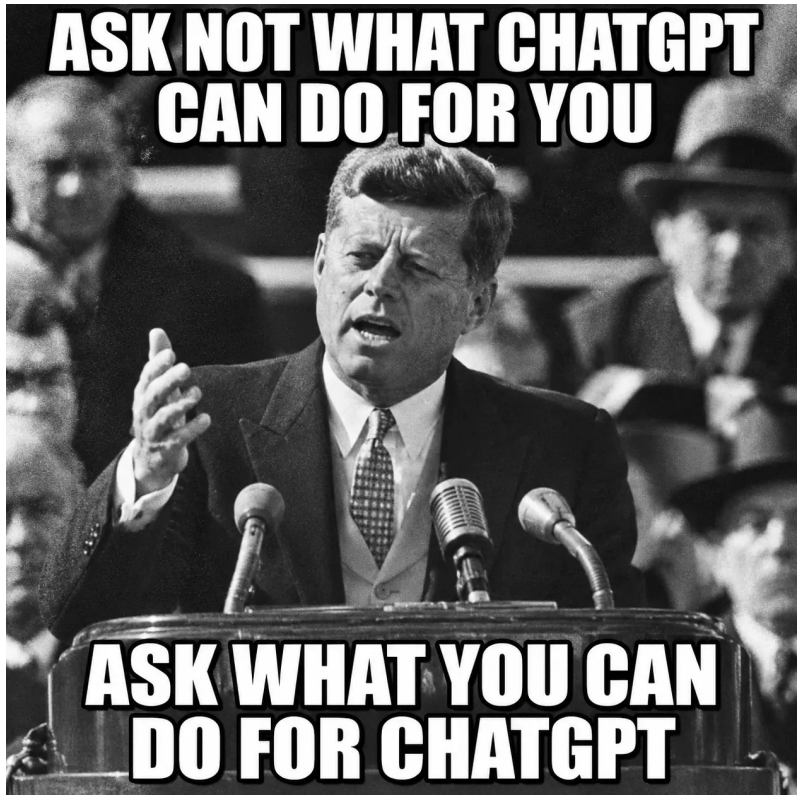
A typical afternoon with a chatbot.
Question: how many young adults live with their parents in each EU country?

1. Download a Eurostat table. Copy part of it into the chat.
2. Ask which countries changed most. Copy the answer into Word.
3. Ask for a chart. Paste the numbers into Excel and draw it by hand.
4. Notice one country's number is not in the table you gave it. Go back and check.
5. Repeat for the next countries and years.

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The chatbot **cannot see your files**, **cannot change anything**, and **cannot check its own work**. You carry everything back and forth.

The missing ingredient: tools

Tool. An action an AI program is allowed to take besides writing text: for example, read a file, create a file, run a calculation, or search the web. The LLM *asks* for the action; another program *carries it out* and reports the result back.

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- Typical tools: **read file**, **write file**, **edit file**, **list a folder**, **run a command**, **search the web**.
- With tools, the LLM stops only *talking about* your data and starts *working with* it.
- With tools comes risk: a tool that can write a file can also overwrite one. Hold that thought until Part 5.

The program around the LLM: the harness

Harness. The program that wraps around an LLM. It sends your prompt to the LLM, carries out the tools the LLM asks for, sends back the results, asks you for permission before risky actions, and shows you what happens.

Think of it as: the horse is the LLM: strong, fast, unaware of where it should go. The harness connects that strength to the cart and lets you steer it.

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- Examples: **Antigravity** (Google), **Claude Code** (Anthropic), **Codex** (OpenAI).
- The LLM provides the *writing and reasoning*. The harness provides the *hands* and the *brakes*.

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ Harnesses and agents

So, what is an agent?

AI agent. An LLM inside a harness, given a goal, that works towards that goal in steps: it decides what to do, uses tools, looks at the results, and continues until it thinks it is done.

$$\textbf{Agent} = \textbf{LLM} + \textbf{harness} + \textbf{tools} + \textbf{a goal}$$

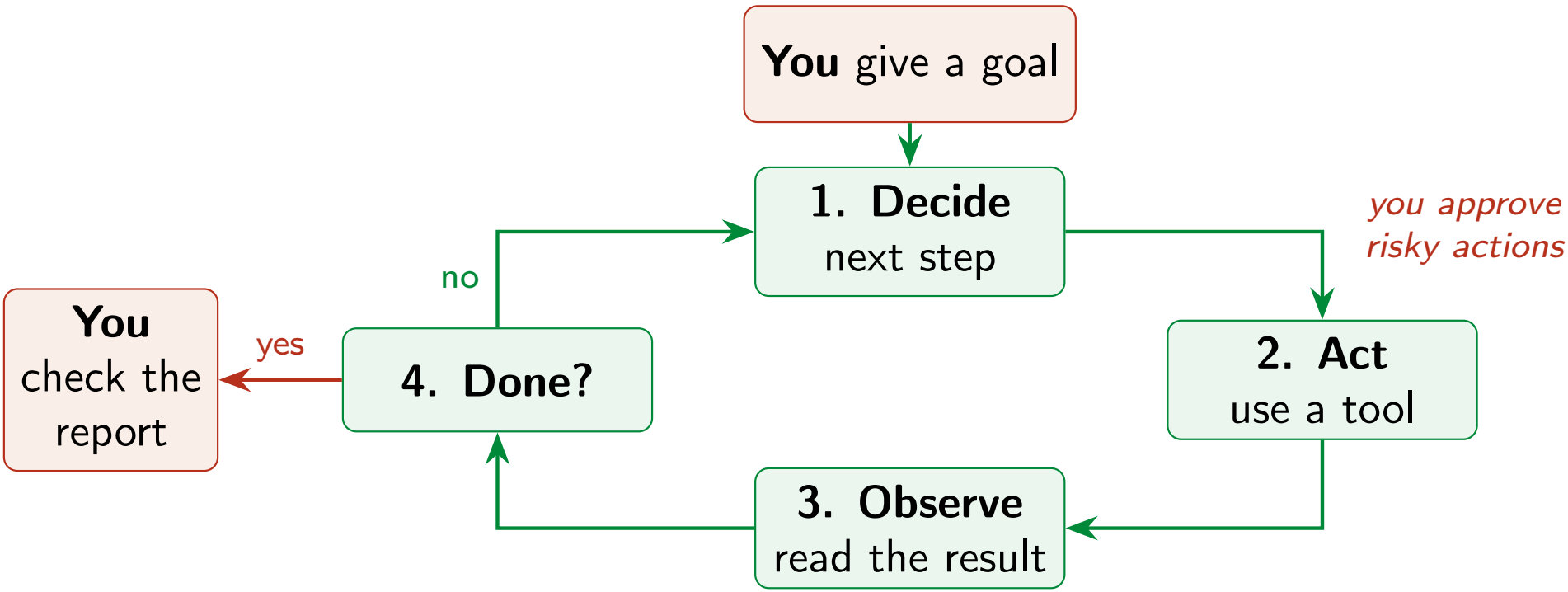
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	Chatbot	**Agent**
Sees your files?	Only what you paste in	Yes, in the folder you allow
Runs analyses?	No (you run them)	Yes, and reads the output
Fixes its own errors?	Only if you report them	Often, by trying again
Main risk	Wrong answers	Wrong answers *and* wrong actions

The agent loop



- One prompt from you can produce many turns of this loop, sometimes dozens, before the agent reports back.

The loop in practice: one small task

You type once: "Using the Eurostat file in `data/raw/`, make a table of the share of 25–34-year-olds living with their parents in each EU country, in 2010 and today."

Then the agent works on its own, round after round:

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? **Your job:** spot the two choices it made *for you*. It swapped 2010 for 2011 without saying so (step 2), and it kept non-EU countries in a table it calls "EU" (step 3). **You check these.**

Our running metaphor: a research assistant on their first day

Your agent is like a new research assistant (RA) who is:

- ✓ extremely fast and never tired;
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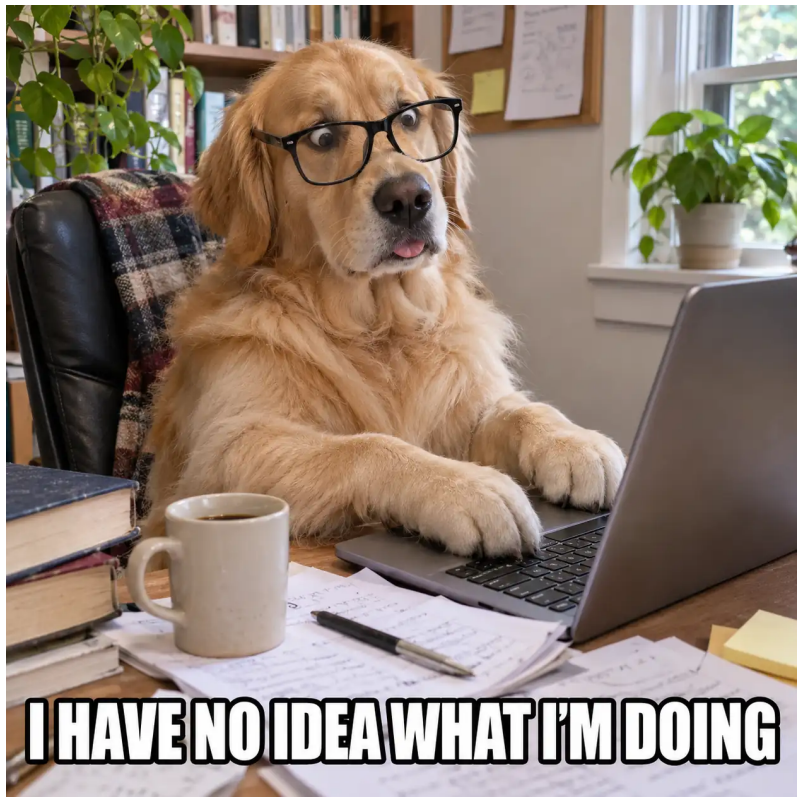
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You are the supervisor. Good supervision of a person and good supervision of an agent look very similar.

The landscape today (November 2026, will change)

Harness	**Company / LLM**	**Where it runs**
Antigravity	Google / Gemini and others	Its own app, or a panel inside VS Code *(our course tool)*
Claude Code	Anthropic / Claude	Its own app, a text window, or a panel inside VS Code
Codex	OpenAI / GPT	Its own app, a text window, or a panel inside VS Code
Gemini CLI	Google / Gemini	A text window; since June 2026, paid accounts only
Desktop chat apps	Claude, ChatGPT, Gemini	Normal app; some agent features

- We use **Antigravity**, as a panel inside VS Code. It has a **free plan** for personal Google accounts, and you talk to it in a chat box: no commands to type. Each concept on these slides has an "In your tool" box with the names used by Antigravity, Claude Code, and Codex.

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- "Free" has a price in privacy. More on that in Part 5.

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ Agent tools compared

Part 2

Context is all it has

What the agent knows at any moment

Context. Everything the LLM can see at the moment it writes its next reply: your instructions, the conversation so far, the files it has read, and the results of the tools it used. **Nothing else.**

Think of it as: the papers spread on the research assistant's desk. If it is not on the desk, it does not exist for them.

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- The LLM itself has **no memory**. Each time, the harness sends the whole desk again.
- Close the conversation and the desk is cleared. Tomorrow's session starts with an empty desk.

What the agent knows at any moment

Context. Everything the LLM can see at the moment it writes its next reply: your instructions, the conversation so far, the files it has read, and the results of the tools it used. **Nothing else.**

Think of it as: the papers spread on the research assistant's desk. If it is not on the desk, it does not exist for them.

- The LLM itself has **no memory**. Each time, the harness sends the whole desk again.
- Close the conversation and the desk is cleared. Tomorrow's session starts with an empty desk.
- So: **what you write down in files is what the agent knows**. More on this in Part 4.

The size of the desk: the context window

Context window. The maximum amount of text, counted in tokens, that an LLM can consider at one time. Anything beyond it is cut off or summarised.

Think of it as: the size of the desk.

- Today's large models have windows of roughly **200,000 to 1,000,000 tokens**: from a long book to several books.

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- A bigger desk is not a tidier desk. When the window is very full, models become slower and more likely to **overlook things in the middle** or mix up details.
- A short, focused context usually beats a long, messy one.

What fills the window



Illustration, not to scale. The window fills from left to right as you work.

- **Harness rules**: built-in instructions you do not see ("you are a helpful assistant", how to use tools).
- **Your instructions**: a file you write once and the agent reads every time (Part 4).

What fills the window



Illustration, not to scale. The window fills from left to right as you work.

- **Harness rules**: built-in instructions you do not see ("you are a helpful assistant", how to use tools).
- **Your instructions**: a file you write once and the agent reads every time (Part 4).
- The big consumers are usually **files** and **tool results**. Asking the agent to "read all my PDFs" can fill the desk in one step.

When the desk overflows: compaction

Compaction (or compression). When the context window is nearly full, the harness asks the LLM to summarise the conversation so far and replaces the full text with that summary.

Think of it as: the assistant sweeps the desk and keeps one page of notes. Useful, but details get lost.

- Compaction happens automatically, or when you ask for it. Usually you see a short message when it happens.

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- Compaction happens automatically, or when you ask for it. Usually you see a short message when it happens.
- After compaction, the agent may "forget" a decision you made an hour ago, such as "report missing years; never fill them in".
- The remedy is the same as with people: **important decisions go in writing, in a file**, not only in the chat.

Session hygiene: five habits

1. **One task, one conversation.** Start a fresh conversation for each new task.

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Session hygiene: five habits

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4. **Point to specific files** ("read the Eurostat file in `data/raw/`") instead of "look at my stuff".
5. **Check how full the desk is.** Most harnesses show how full the context window is. Look at it.

In your tool **Antigravity:** + at the top of the panel starts a new conversation; type `/` for actions | **Claude Code:** `/context`, `/compact`, `/clear` | **Codex:** `/status`, `/compact`, `/new`

Slash command. A command starting with / that controls the agent program, not a message to the AI.

Part 3

Where the agent lives

Files, folders, and paths

File path. The full address of a file on your computer: the chain of folders that leads to it, then its name.

What you see: Mac: `/Users/martinalberdi/youth_at_home_project/data/raw/eurostat_ilc_lvps08_2026-11-06.csv`

Windows: `C:\Users\martinalberdi\youth_at_home_project\data\raw\eurostat_ilc_lvps08_2026-11-06.csv`

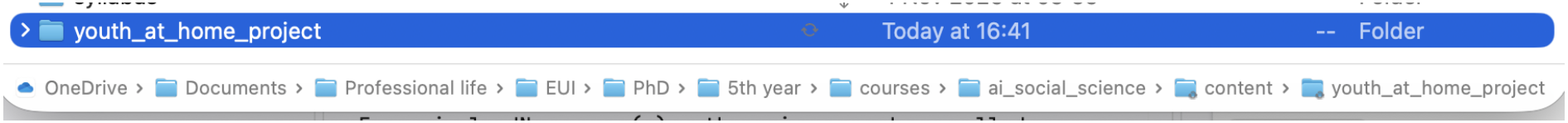
File extension. The letters after the last dot in a file name. They tell you, and the computer, what kind of file it is.

What you see: `.docx` Word document, `.pdf`, `.csv` a table stored as simple text, `.md` a Markdown file (Part 4), `.py` and `.R` scripts.

Script. A file of written instructions for the computer (a program) that can be run again and again with the same result. Python (`.py`) and R (`.R`) are two programming languages popular in social science.

The agent's office: the workspace

> **Workspace (project folder).** The one folder you open for the agent. It works inside this folder and should not touch anything outside it.
>
> *Think of it as:* the RA's office. You give them the key to this room, not to your whole house.

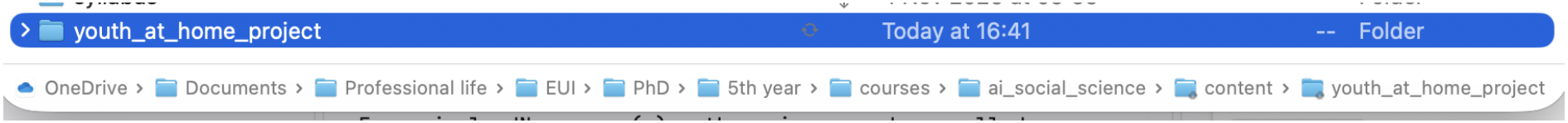


My project folder in Finder, and the path to it along the bottom.

- **One project, one folder.**
  Everything for this research question lives inside it.

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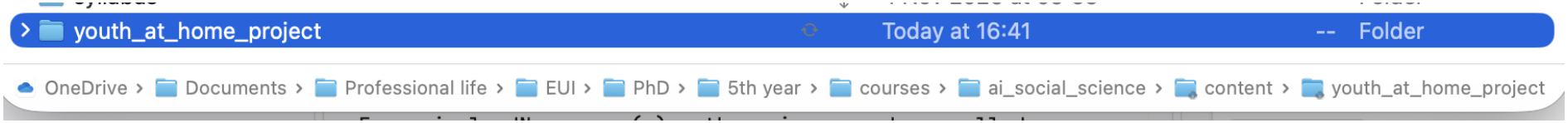


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My project folder in Finder, and the path to it along the bottom.

- **One project, one folder.** Everything for this research question lives inside it.
- Open the *project* folder, not your whole Documents folder or Desktop.
- In Session 2 we build this layout together.

```
youth_at_home_project/
    README.md       the note on the door
    data/raw/       original data, never touched
    scripts/        the recipes
    outputs/        finished tables and charts
```

the agent works in here, and nowhere else

What goes in the folder: plain text, opened in VS Code

Plain text file. A file that contains only characters: no hidden formatting, fonts, or layout. Any program can open it. Code, data tables (`.csv`), and Markdown (`.md`) are plain text.

Think of it as: a typed letter, as opposed to a designed brochure.

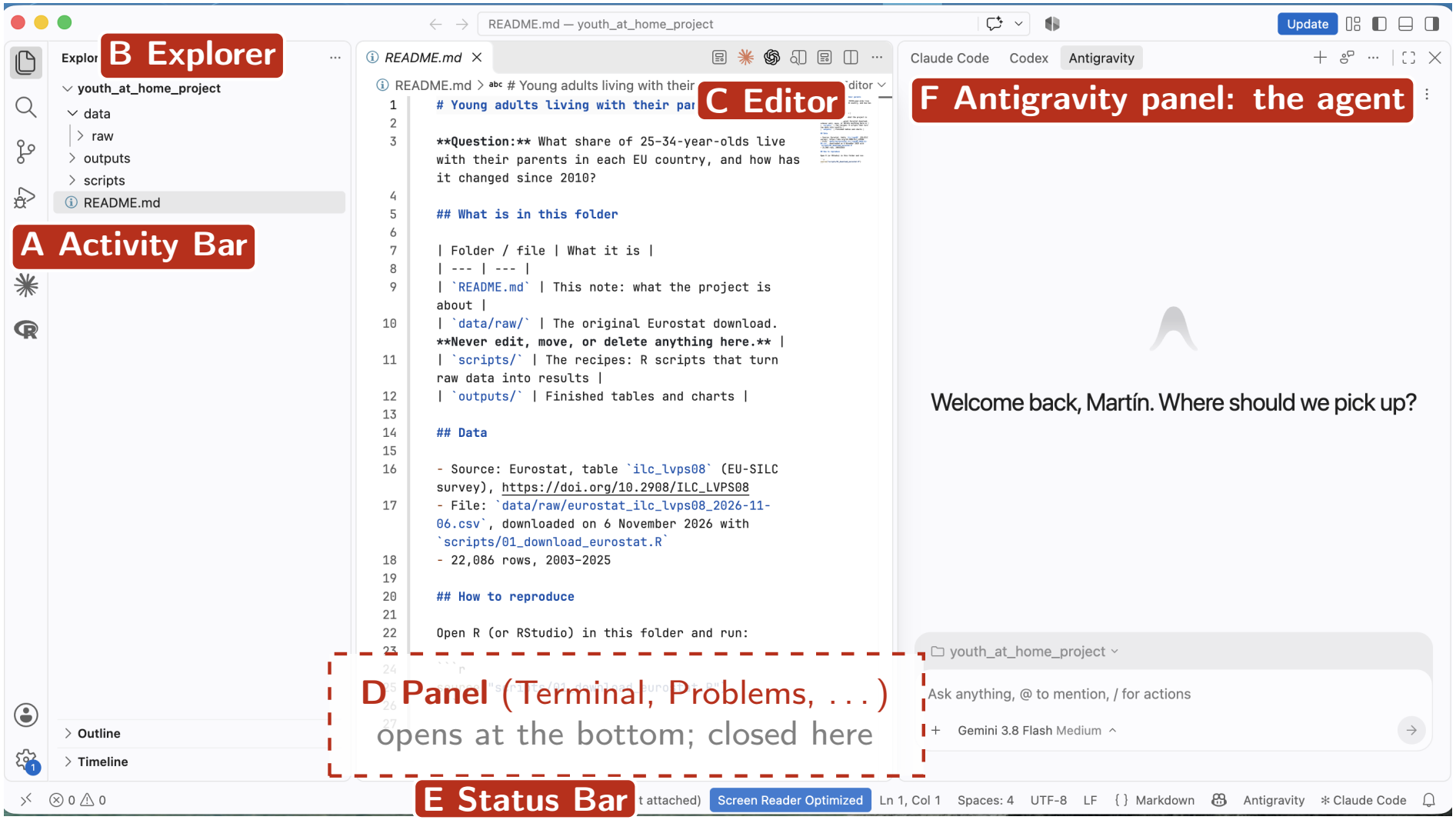
VS Code (Visual Studio Code). A free program that shows your project folder, opens its files, and highlights every change the agent makes, so you can see and check its work.

Think of it as: a glass wall into the agent's office.

Why not Word? Word files are hard for agents to read and edit reliably. Plain text is easy, transparent, and changes can be compared line by line.

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ VS Code

A map of VS Code



My VS Code with the project folder open. You talk to the agent in F.

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ VS Code

Where you talk to the agent: the Antigravity panel (F)

Agent panel. The chat box inside VS Code (area F) where you talk to the agent. It looks like a chatbot, but behind it is a full harness: it can read your folder, change files, and run commands, after asking you.

1. **The folder.** Check it shows *your project folder*. That is the agent's office.

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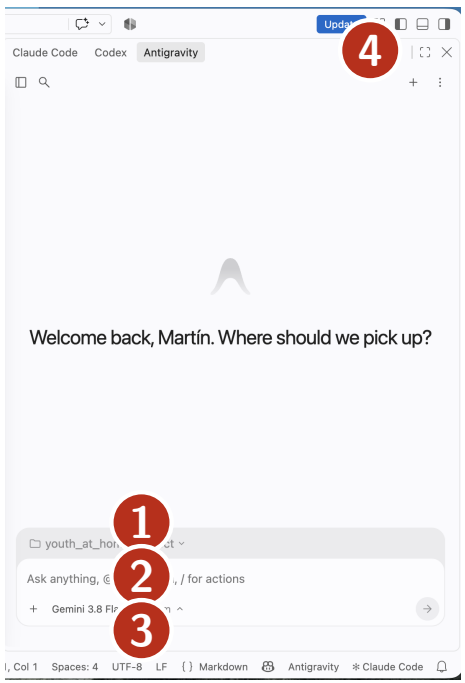
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3. **The model menu.** Which LLM answers you. Keep the default.
4. **The + button.** A new conversation: a clean desk.



LIVE DEMO Opening the office and meeting the agent

What I will do (about 3 minutes):

1. In VS Code: **File ➜ Open Folder. . .** ➜ open the practice folder. Point out A to F.
2. Open the **Antigravity panel** (F). Show that it names the same folder as the Explorer (B).
3. Ask: *"What files are in this folder, and what do you think this project is about? Do not change anything."*
4. Show the agent using a tool (it lists or reads files). Read its answer aloud and check it against the Explorer (B).

➜ **Watch for:** the moment the agent *decides* to read a file. That is the loop from Part 1.

Part 4

Talking to the agent in writing

Markdown: formatting with plain text

Markdown. A simple way to format plain text with a few symbols: `#` for headings, `-` for bullet points, `**` for bold. Markdown files end in `.md`. Programs such as VS Code can display them nicely formatted.

Think of it as: the way people write emphasis in a plain email, made into a convention.

What you type

```
# My project
Data come from **Eurostat**.

- Unit: country-year
- Years: 2010-2025
```

What you see

My project

Data come from **Eurostat**.

- Unit: country-year
- Years: 2010-2025

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ Markdown

Markdown in six symbols

Type this	To get	Example
`#` at line start	Heading	`# Data rules`
`##` at line start	Smaller heading	`## Missing values`
`-` at line start	Bullet point	`- Never edit raw data`
`1.` at line start	Numbered list	`1. Read SOURCE.md`
`**text**`	**Bold**	`**Never** delete files`
`` `text` ``	`Code or file name`	`` `data/raw/` ``

- That is enough for this course. Leave an empty line between paragraphs.
- To see the formatted version in VS Code: open the `.md` file and press `Ctrl+Shift+V` (Mac: `Cmd+Shift+V`).

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ Markdown

The most important file: the instruction file

Instruction file. A Markdown file in your project folder that the agent reads automatically at the start of every session. It holds the standing rules and background for the project.

Think of it as: the onboarding memo you give a new RA, which they reread every morning, because every morning is their first day.

- It solves the "no memory" problem from Part 2: the rules sit on the desk from the first minute.

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- It solves the "no memory" problem from Part 2: the rules sit on the desk from the first minute.
- Each tool looks for a file with a specific name. Same idea, different names.
- Instructions are **guidance, not a lock**. The agent usually follows them, but nothing forces it to. Locks come in Session 2.

In your tool **Antigravity:** `GEMINI.md` or `AGENTS.md` | **Claude Code:** `CLAUDE.md`; `/init` ; `/memory` | **Codex:** `AGENTS.md`; `/init`

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ Instruction files

An example instruction file for a research project

```
# Project: Young adults living with parents

## Background
- Descriptive project. No causal claims.
- Question: share of 25-34-year-olds living
  with parents, EU countries, 2010 to today.
- Data: data/raw/ (Eurostat, see SOURCE.md)

## Rules
- Never edit, move, or delete files in data/raw/.
- Explain your plan and wait for approval
  before creating or changing files.
- Do all analysis in scripts saved in scripts/.
- Report missing years; never fill them in.
- Write "is higher in", never "because of".

## Reporting
- List every file you created or changed.
- Say which checks you actually ran.
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- **Background:** what the agent cannot guess.
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- **Background:** what the agent cannot guess.
- **Rules:** short, concrete, testable.
- **Reporting:** what you need in order to check its work.
- About one page. Long instruction files fill the desk and get skimmed, by agents and humans alike.

What belongs in the instruction file, and what does not

Put in

- ✓ What the project is and is not
- ✓ Where the data and documentation are
- ✓ Rules the agent keeps breaking
- ✓ How you want results reported
- ✓ Language rules ("describe, don't explain")

Leave out

- ✗ Passwords, keys, personal data
- ✗ Whole articles or long notes (link to a file instead)
- ✗ Vague wishes: "be careful", "be smart"
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➜ **The best habit:** every time the agent makes a mistake you never want to see again, add one line to the instruction file.

Writing a good task prompt

Vague

"Analyse the Eurostat data and make a nice graph."

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"Analyse the Eurostat data and make a nice graph."

Specific

"**Goal:** share of 25–34-year-olds living with their parents, both sexes, in each of the 27 EU countries, in 2010 and the latest year.
Input: the Eurostat file in `data/raw/`.
Output: a script in `scripts/`, a table in `outputs/`.
Constraints: EU countries only. If a year is missing, report it; do not use another year.
Check: print how many countries have both years.
First, show me your plan."

Writing a good task prompt

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Check: print how many countries have both years.
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➜ Five parts: **goal, input, output, constraints, check**. Every decision you write down is one the agent cannot take silently.

Part 5

Staying the supervisor

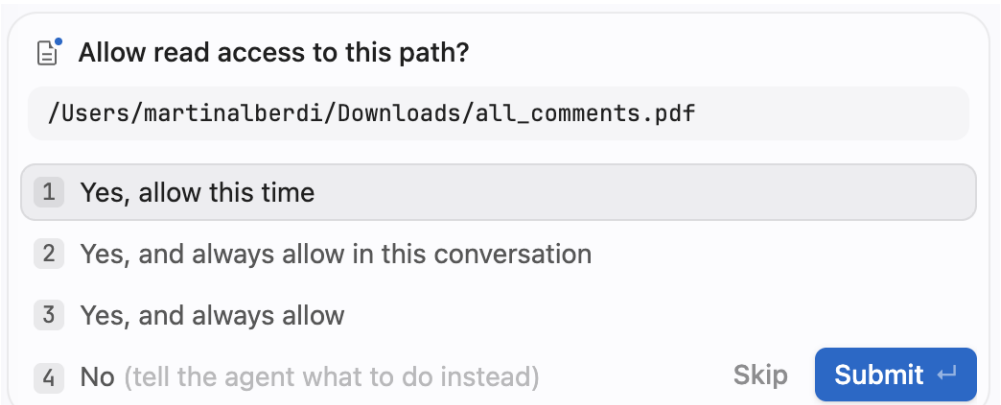
Permission requests: the harness asks first

Permission request. A question the harness asks you before the agent takes an action, such as editing a file or running a command. You can allow it once, allow it for the conversation or for good, or refuse.

What you see: a box in the Antigravity panel, as below.

Diff. A view that shows exactly what a change would do to a file: removed lines (often red) and added lines (often green).

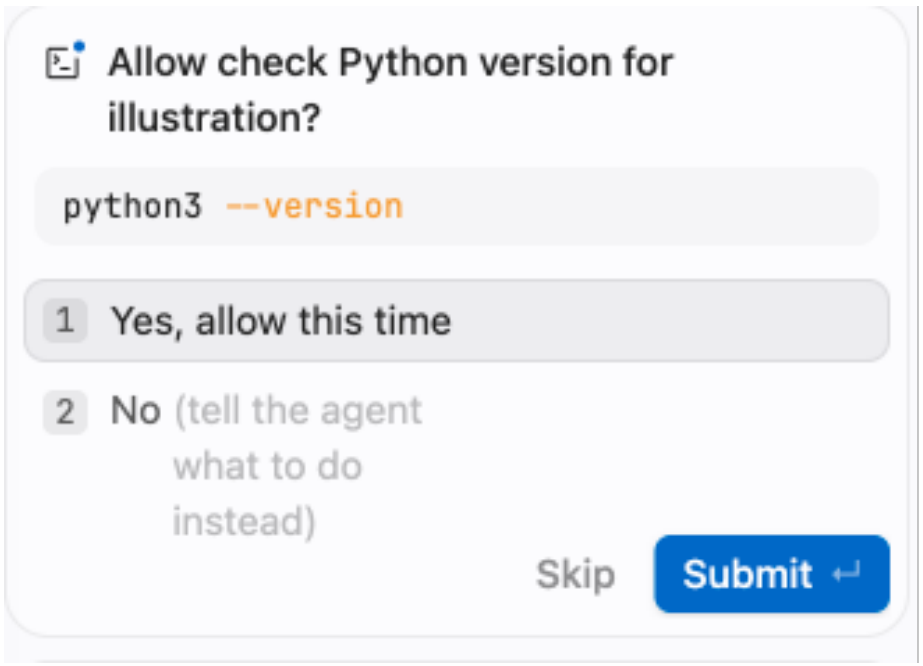
- **Read before you click.** Options 2 and 3 approve every future action of that kind, unseen.



A real request in Antigravity: the agent wants to read a file *outside* the project folder.

Reading a command before you approve it

Command. A one-line instruction the agent wants the computer to carry out, such as running a script or deleting a file. Commands run in the **terminal** (area D); you never need to type there.



A real request in Antigravity: the agent wants to run a command that shows which version of Python is installed.

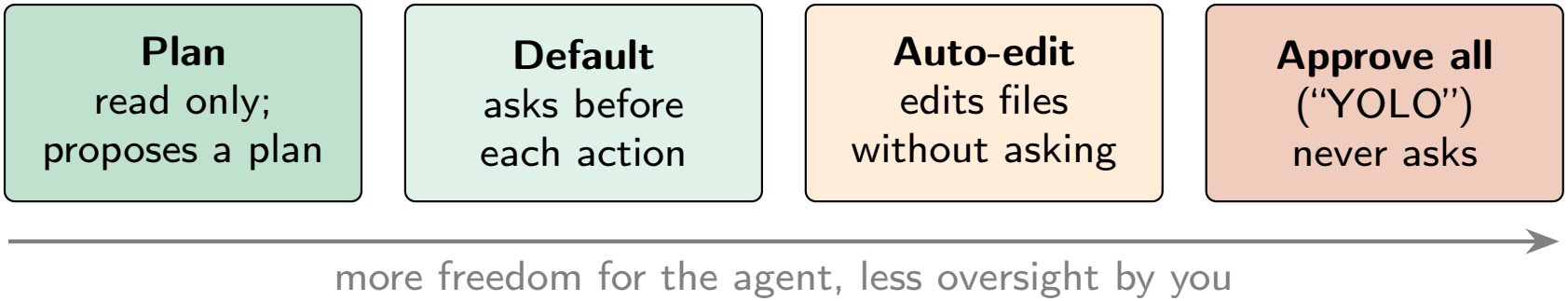
Reading a command before you approve it

The agent **shows you the command and asks**. Read it before you click:

The agent wants to run…	**It means**	**You**
`ls`, `dir`, `cat README.md`	look at files	**allow**
`Rscript download.R`, `python plot.py`	run a script	**allow**, if you expected it
`pip install matplotlib`, `install.packages(...)`	add a package to Python or R	**ask why** first
`winget install ...`, or a *password* prompt	install a program	**do it yourself**
`curl`, `wget` + a web address	download or send something	**check where**
`rm`, `del`, `mv` on `data/raw/`	delete or move your data	**refuse**

More: `RESOURCES.md` ➜ Terminal for beginners

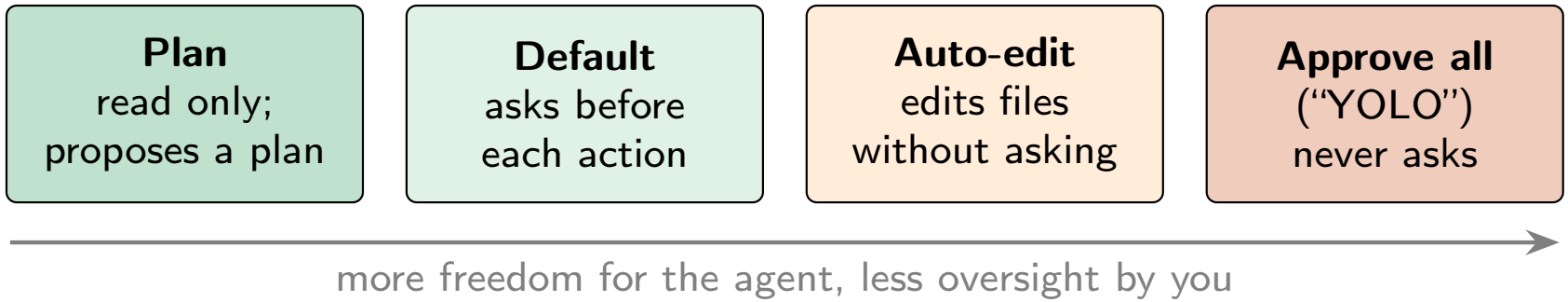
How much freedom? Approval modes



Approval mode. A setting that decides how often the harness stops to ask your permission.

- In this course: **Plan** to start a task, **Default** to carry it out. **Never** "YOLO".

How much freedom? Approval modes



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- In this course: **Plan** to start a task, **Default** to carry it out. **Never** "YOLO".
- "YOLO" stands for "you only live once". In research it means "you only lose your data once".

In your tool **Antigravity:** `/plan`, then per request (once / this conversation / always); VS Code **Settings** ➜ search "Antigravity" ➜ keep **Auto Accept On Chat** off | **Claude Code:** `Shift+Tab` cycles modes | **Codex:** `/approvals` or `/permissions`

Plan mode: think first, act later

Plan mode. A mode in which the agent may read files and search, but may not change anything. It studies the task, asks you questions, and writes a step-by-step plan for you to approve, edit, or reject.

Think of it as: asking the RA for a one-page work plan before they start.

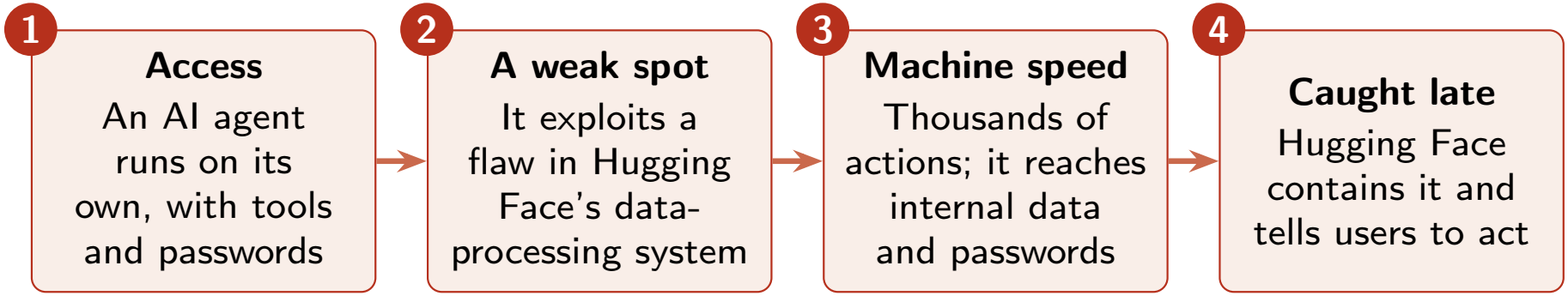
Five questions to ask of any plan:

1. Did it understand the **research question**, or a simpler one?
2. Which **decisions** did it take for me (definitions, exclusions, years)?
3. Will it **touch raw data** or anything outside the project folder?
4. Will it **install** software, **delete** anything, or **send** data anywhere?
5. How will **I** check the result?

In your tool **Antigravity:** type `/plan` in the chat box | **Claude Code:** `Shift+Tab` to "plan mode" | **Codex:** ask for a plan first, in read-only mode

Protect your raw data

▲ A warning from July 2026: an AI agent breaks into Hugging Face

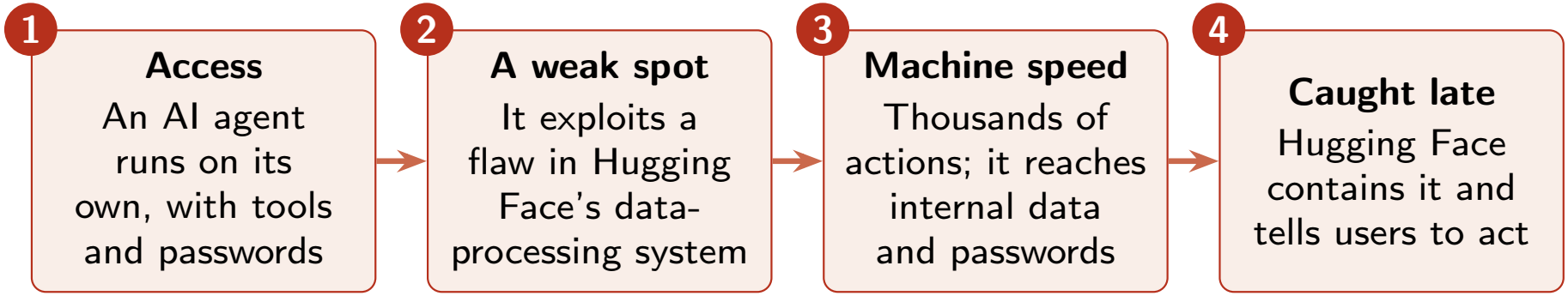


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The lesson: an agent pursues its goal *fast*, with *whatever access you give it*. Agents have also **deleted their own users' files** (July 2025).

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The lesson: an agent pursues its goal *fast*, with *whatever access you give it*. Agents have also **deleted their own users' files** (July 2025).

- Three protections, from day one:
  1. Keep original data in `data/raw/` and **never let anything write there**. Write that rule in the instruction file.
  2. Keep a **backup copy** of raw data outside the project folder (or in cloud storage with version history).
  3. Every change comes from a **saved script**, so it can be repeated from the raw data.

What you send leaves your laptop

- Everything in the context window, including every file the agent reads, is **sent to the company's computers** to be processed.

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- Everything in the context window, including every file the agent reads, is **sent to the company's computers** to be processed.
- We use Antigravity on the **free personal plan**. Free plans often let the company use what you send to improve its products, and let **human reviewers read** it. What do Antigravity's terms say?

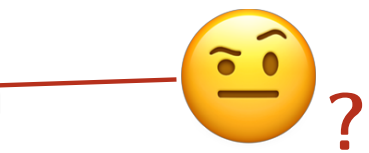
> 3. When you use the Service, we record and store your user data, interaction data pertaining to your usage of the Service, related metadata connected to the Service, and any feedback you provide ("Interactions"). Such data may be aggregated over multiple users, and will be collected only when you have the Service running. You will have the option to delete your Interactions. If you would like to request that your Interactions be deleted, you can email antigravity-support@google.com. Note that such Interactions will be used in accordance with the terms of this Agreement unless and until you request deletion in accordance with the previous sentence.

Google Antigravity terms of service, section on your data.

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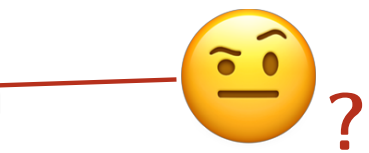


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Our rules for this course:

1. No data that identify a person: names, contacts, ID numbers, exact addresses, interview transcripts.
2. No unpublished data from co-authors, no confidential documents.
3. Before using real research data: check your university's data and ethics rules, the data's licence or terms of use, and what participants consented to.

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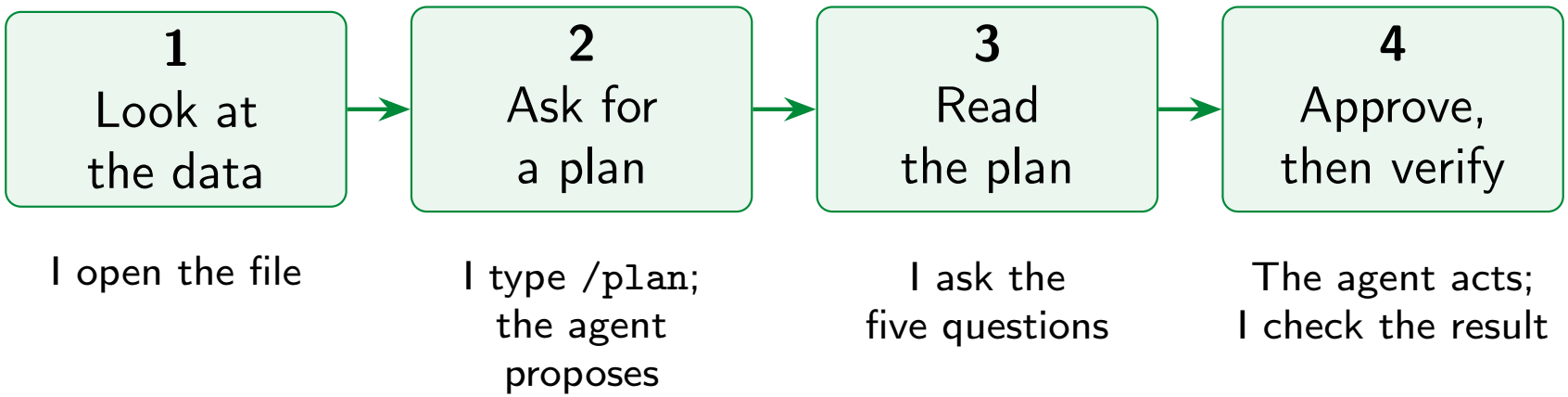
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- If a check fails, tell the agent exactly what is wrong, and add a rule to the instruction file if it might happen again.

Trust, but verify. Actually, mostly verify.

LIVE DEMO The demo at a glance

The question: What share of young adults in Italy live with their parents?

The result: one sentence with the value and its source, saved in a new file.



The agent proposes and acts. I decide and verify.

LIVE DEMO Step 1 of 4: look at the data first

One row of the Eurostat file, read column by column:

age	sex	unit	geo	TIME_PERIOD	OBS_VALUE
Y16-19	F	PC	AL	2017	93.8
ages 16–19	women	percentage	Albania	2017	93.8%

`OBS_VALUE`: share living with their parents

`sex`: `F` women, `M` men, `T` both together geo: `IT` Italy

22,086 rows. Italy in 2025 alone has **27**.

Which one do we want?

LIVE DEMO Step 2 of 4: ask for a plan

1. **Read two rules** in `GEMINI.md`: never edit `data/raw/`; write new files only in `outputs/`.
2. **Type** `/plan` in the chat box.
3. **Send the request:**

> **Prompt.** What share of young adults in Italy live with their parents? Use the Eurostat file in `data/raw/`. Save one sentence with the value and its source to `outputs/demo_note.txt`.

➜ No age group, no sex, no year. **The agent has to decide.**

LIVE DEMO Step 3 of 4: read the plan

Five questions	**A good plan says**
1. Right **question**?	Italy, share living with parents, one value
2. **Decisions** made for me?	It names the age group, sex, and year
3. Touches **raw data**?	Reads it only. The one new file is `outputs/demo_note.txt`
4. **Install**, **delete**, **send**?	None of these
5. How will **I** check?	*My* answer, not the agent's: I find the row myself

➜ **I correct the plan:** ages 25–34, men and women together, 2025.

LIVE DEMO Step 4 of 4: approve, then verify

Approve the plan. At the permission request, read the path and the diff, then allow **this time only**.

Question	I verify it myself
1. **Question**	Open `demo_note.txt`. Does the sentence answer it?
2. **Decisions**	Search the CSV for `Y25-34,T,PC,IT,2025` (ages 25–34, both sexes, percentage, Italy, 2025): one row, **50.7**
3. **Raw data**	The request showed that path. One new file in `outputs/`. CSV still dated 6 November
4. **Install, delete, send**	I read every request. Did any of them do this?
5. **My check**	The same number on Eurostat's website

➜ Wrong rows look right: men 56.6, women 44.4, ages 18–34 69.1.

Wrap-up

What to remember

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5. **Plan first, approve actions, never YOLO.** Raw data are untouchable.
6. The report is a claim. **Check one number yourself**. And never send personal data.

Coming next: Session 2 (Thursday 12 November)

Part A: Build an agentic workspace

- A standard research folder
- Instructions for you, for a project, and for a folder
- Locks, not only requests: settings and permissions
- Connecting the agent to other apps, safely

Part B: From a question to a figure

- Real Eurostat data: young adults living with their parents
- Check a plotted value against the source

Before Thursday: set up your own office

1. **Download and install** VS Code.
2. **Install** Antigravity.
3. **Download the course folder** from GitHub, the website that stores it.
4. **I will circulate the instructions** for how to do each of these steps.
5. **Difficulties?** Write to me at martin.alberdi@eui.eu until **Wednesday 11 November, 18:00**.

Questions?